



ChatGPT 4o mini ▾

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- **Key Rule:** Modern compilers often perform aggressive optimization, and inlining may be handled automatically. The use of `inline` might not always improve performance, as the compiler may already optimize function calls.
- **Reason:** Sometimes, compilers might choose to inline functions automatically or refrain from inlining large functions to avoid bloating the binary.
- **Example** (compiler may ignore `inline`):

c

Copy code

```
inline int add(int a, int b) {  
    return a + b; // Compiler might inline it automatically or decide not to  
}
```

Best Practices:

- Use `inline` for small, frequently used functions with simple code (e.g., accessor methods, small mathematical operations).
- Avoid using `inline` for large or complex functions that might result in excessive code duplication.
- Define `inline` functions in header files to make them accessible across translation units.
- Use the `static` keyword if the inline function is meant to be restricted to a single translation unit.
- Be mindful of **code bloat** when inlining large functions or using `inline` excessively.

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